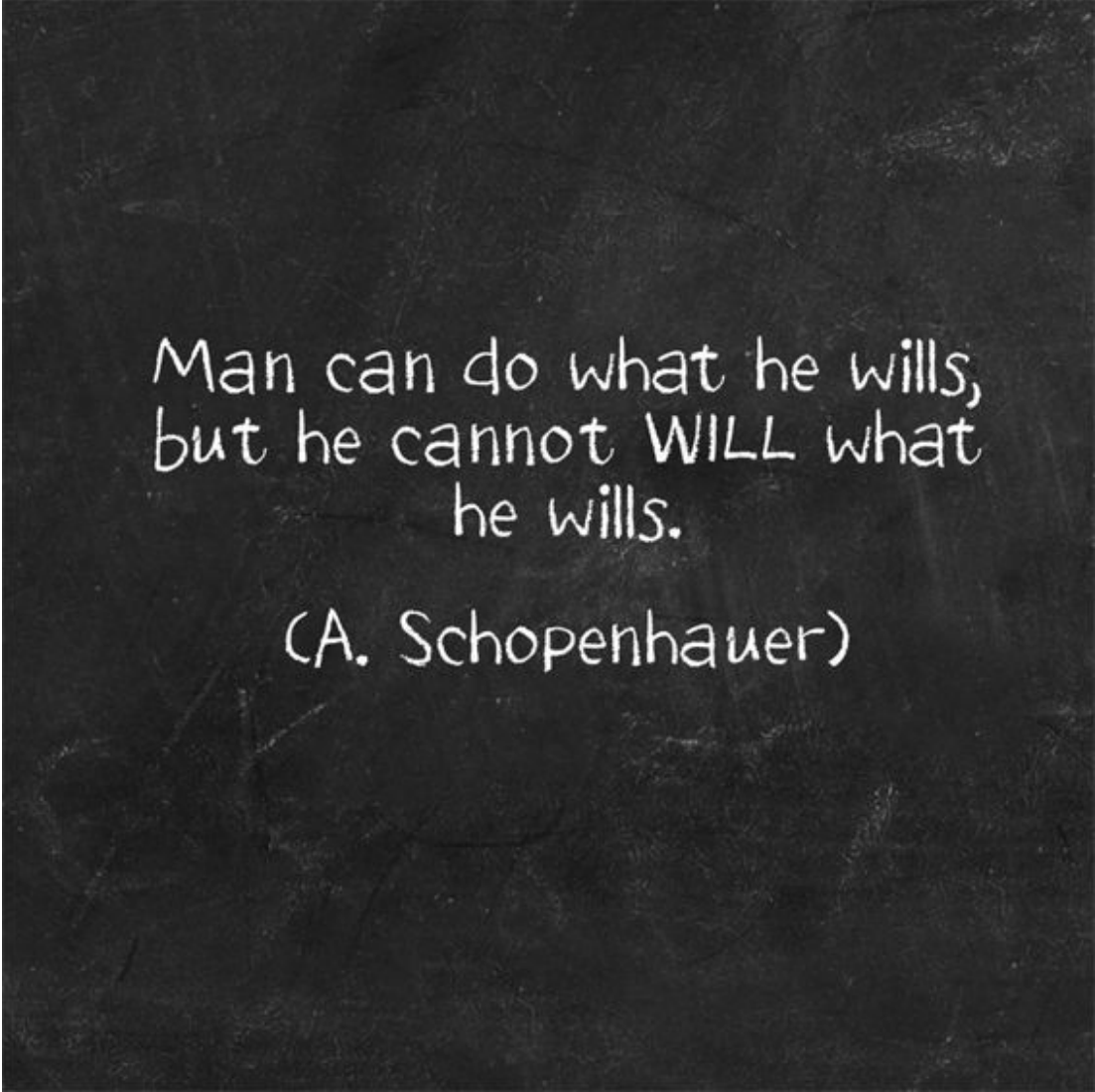


The World as Will and Representation



Man can do what he wills,
but he cannot WILL what
he wills.

(A. Schopenhauer)

Arthur Schopenhauer was a great admirer of Kant and avidly absorbed his idea of phenomenon and noumenon. In his book *The World as Will and Representation* (1818) he took the idea a step further, proposing that there are not two separate worlds, but one world with two different aspects. What Kant described as the noumenal world cannot consist of things-in-themselves, Schopenhauer argued, as in order to be different from one another they would have to exist in different places in time or space – and time and space are a part of the phenomenal world. What's more, noumena cannot cause phenomena, as causality also only exists in the phenomenal

world; so acts of will (which are noumenal) cannot cause things like bodily movement. He concluded that Will and movement are therefore one and the same thing. The phenomenal and noumenal are not separate worlds but the same, experienced in two different ways: Will from within, and Representation, from outside. We can experience our own Will, but only the Representation, not the inner Will, of other things.